

SCALLIONS AND BUNCHING ONIONS

Allium cepa

Mostly enjoyed as a salad vegetable when their stems are still slender, scallions will also develop into sizeable bulbs if left in the ground to grow on. Bunching onions can be harvested at scallion size, or allowed to mature to the size of leeks. Both are very easy to raise and need minimal care.

	SPRING	SUMMER	FALL	WINTER
SOW				
HARVEST				

SOWING

Grown from seed, scallions and bunching onions need a sunny, fertile, well-drained site and will not do well on very acid soils. Test the pH levels of your soil and add lime if necessary. Dig in plenty of well-rotted manure or compost before sowing.

Sow the seed directly into the ground from early spring. If you want to harvest scallions throughout the summer, sow successive batches at two-weekly intervals until the fall. You can also sow hardy varieties in the fall for overwintering crops that will be ready to harvest the following spring.

Prepare shallow drills .5–.75 in (1–2 cm) deep and 12 in (30 cm) apart, and space the seeds about



Pull scallions as required.

.5 in (1 cm) apart. Carefully rake back the soil to cover the drills. Plants will not need thinning.

CROP CARE

Weed the bed regularly and water if the weather is very dry, since this can cause the onions to become bulbous. If you live in an area where there is a high risk of frosts, protect overwintering crops with cloches.